

BUSINESS PLAN STANDARD

Build the plan before the investment. Verify the assumptions before the decision.

CONTROLLED DOCUMENT

CLASSIFICATION	CONFIDENTIAL / INTERNAL / OWNER + NAMED AUTHORITY
EDITION	01 / SEPTEMBER 2026
APPLICATION	PRE-INVESTMENT BUSINESS PLANNING / ASSUMPTION CONTROL / DECISION
AUTHORITY	OWNER / NAMED PLANNING AUTHORITY
NEXT REVIEW	SEPTEMBER 2027 OR EARLIER AFTER MATERIAL CONCEPT / SITE / CAPITAL CHANGE
SITE	
ACTIVITY	

PLAN. VERIFY. DECIDE.

01

Purpose and limits

This Standard controls the planning method. It does not guarantee the business, the market, or the outcome.

The Business Plan Standard governs how the house organizes a proposed business concept, market evidence, operating assumptions, local constraints, asset needs, systems, investment picture, risk, and the decision to move forward. Its purpose is to make the planning logic visible before material capital is committed.

GOVERNS	DOES NOT REPLACE
Concept and model. What the business intends to do, for whom, where, and how the activity may generate revenue.	Launch Roadmap, Forecasting, Road Beyond Launch, Standard Operating Procedures, Fleet Standard, Local Rules, Agreement / Execution Packet, or Training controls.
Assumption control. The source and quality of numbers, claims, quotes, estimates, and local requirements used to support a planning decision.	A lender package, formal valuation, legal opinion, insurance determination, investment recommendation, tax advice, or guarantee of demand or profitability.
Planning decision. A controlled owner decision based on what has actually been verified and what still remains open.	A complete operating manual, customer contract, fleet unit record, three-year forecasting model, or post-launch growth system.

BOUNDARY

The Standard organizes the decision before the investment. It does not turn an assumption into a fact and it does not convert a plan into proof of future performance.

02

What a plan is

A plan is a controlled set of assumptions the owner can explain, source, test, and change.

01

A WORKING POSITION

The plan states the business idea as it is understood now. It is expected to change when evidence improves.

02

A SOURCE MAP

Important claims and numbers show where they came from - verified quote, owner estimate, research, or professional input.

03

A DECISION FILE

The plan records what must be true before the owner moves capital, signs a major commitment, or proceeds to the next planning stage.

04

A RESEARCH CONTROL

A blank section means the research is unfinished. Silence is not approval, confirmation, or a hidden yes.

PLANNING RULE

The plan must be defensible enough that another authorized person can distinguish what is known, what is estimated, what is still open, and what would change the decision.

A finished-looking page is not the objective. The objective is controlled reasoning before capital moves. If the business cannot explain the basis for a material assumption, that assumption remains open.

Assumption control

Every material number or claim carries a source status. Unlabeled information cannot support a GO decision.

SOURCE STATUS	WHAT IT MEANS	HOW IT MAY BE USED
VERIFIED QUOTE	A current written quote, official source, professional confirmation, contract proposal, or other retained evidence supports the figure or requirement.	May support the plan when the date, scope, and source are current enough for the decision being made.
OWNER ESTIMATE	A planning estimate created by the owner from stated assumptions. It is not presented as an outside quote or confirmed market fact.	May be used for scenario planning when clearly labeled and stress-tested against uncertainty.
UNLABELED / UNKNOWN	The source, date, basis, or verification status cannot be identified.	Not usable as support for GO. Research, verify, relabel, or remove before the decision relies on it.

NO SILENT UPGRADE

Repeating an estimate does not make it verified. Copying a number from an old plan does not make it current. If the source changes, the planning record changes with it.

For material figures, the business should be able to state the source, date, scope, and whether the number is a verified quote or an owner estimate. The detailed model, sensitivity work, and multi-period projections belong in Forecasting when that resource is used.

Section discipline

Each planning section has a job. The Business Plan stays a plan instead of becoming a storage drawer for every other document.

SECTION	BELONGS HERE	DOES NOT BELONG HERE
Identity	Business name, ownership / authority, site, structure status, planning date and scope.	Sensitive account numbers, credentials, full legal file, or private banking records.
Offer	What the business intends to sell or rent, to whom, and the basic revenue logic.	Shopping list of default services, product catalog, or invented expansion menu.
Market	Demand evidence, alternatives, customer problem, seasonality, and verified market observations.	Generic platform assignments or marketing channels treated as mandatory.
Local constraints	Registration, licensing, site, insurance availability, storage, access, and other conditions that affect feasibility.	Unverified local claims presented as confirmed requirements.
Operations sketch	High-level operating model, authority, customer flow, and major dependencies.	Full SOP, detailed pickup steps, incident procedures, or staff training modules.
Assets + systems	What must exist to operate and what must be sourced, configured, stored, or controlled.	Fleet unit logs, preventive records, or vendor-specific shopping list as policy.
Money + risk	Startup picture, recurring operating picture, working capital, contingency, material risks, and figure sources.	Full multi-year forecasting novel, customer waiver, or detailed accounting ledger.
Next action	Open research, professional review, pre-capital conditions, decision, owner, and date.	A hidden assumption that the business is already approved to proceed.

Local constraints before capital

Verify whether the concept can legally, practically, and insurably operate at the intended site before buying the fleet or making major commitments.

CONSTRAINT FAMILY	PLANNING QUESTION	MINIMUM CONTROL
Registration + licence	What registrations, permits, licences, tax registrations, or activity approvals apply here?	Current source identified. Open questions stay open.
Site + use	Can the proposed activity actually operate, store assets, receive customers, and move equipment from this site?	Site restrictions and permissions verified before dependent capital is committed.
Insurance availability	Is appropriate coverage available for the activity, assets, site, operators, and business model?	Availability and material conditions verified through the appropriate source.
Storage + access	Can the business safely and practically store, secure, clean, charge / fuel where applicable, and access the assets?	Physical constraints are treated as feasibility controls, not afterthoughts.
Operating restrictions	Do local, property, or activity restrictions change the offer, hours, zone, driver rules, or customer promise?	Current rule source identified and linked to the Local Rules system when applicable.

CAPITAL GATE

Do not buy the fleet first and research the location later. If a material site, licence, registration, insurance, storage, or access condition is unresolved, the plan remains in research or adjustment.

The plan does not decide local law. It records what has been verified, by whom or through which source, what remains uncertain, and how that uncertainty affects the investment decision.

06

Money picture

The Business Plan states the investment picture and the source of the figures. Detailed forecasting remains separate.

01

STARTUP

One-time or pre-opening commitments required to reach controlled launch. Each material figure should identify whether it is a verified quote or an owner estimate.

02

OPERATING

Recurring costs required to keep the business operating. The plan states the major categories and the planning basis without becoming the bookkeeping ledger.

03

WORKING CAPITAL

Liquidity reserved to support the operating cycle before cash collections and expenses settle into a reliable pattern. It is named separately from asset purchase cost.

04

CONTINGENCY

A separately identified planning allowance for uncertainty. It is not used to hide missing research or make an underfunded plan appear complete.

SOURCE THE FIGURE

The plan should state both the amount and the basis. If detailed monthly assumptions, seasonality, cash flow, break-even, debt service, or multi-year scenarios are needed, use Forecasting rather than expanding this Standard into a second financial model.

Startup and operating costs answer different questions. Working capital and contingency also serve different purposes. Keeping them visible helps the owner see what must be funded before the business is treated as ready to move.

Planning decision

The owner closes the current planning cycle with one controlled decision and a written pre-capital condition.

01

GO

The current evidence supports moving to the next controlled step. GO does not waive unresolved conditions named in the decision.

02

ADJUST

The concept remains viable enough to continue, but the offer, site, scope, capital plan, timing, or other material assumption must change first.

03

CONTINUE RESEARCHING

The business does not yet have enough verified information to support capital movement or the next major commitment.

04

RECONSIDER

One or more assumptions materially weaken the concept. The owner re-examines whether this model, site, activity, scale, or timing should continue.

DECISION RECORD MUST IDENTIFY	WHY IT MATTERS
Named authority + date	The decision belongs to an accountable person and a defined planning version.
What must be true before capital moves	GO or ADJUST is not permission to skip a condition that was material to the planning decision.
Open professional review	Legal, insurance, tax, finance, property, technical, or other review remains visible instead of being buried.
Next controlled document	The record identifies whether the next work belongs in Forecasting, the Launch Roadmap, Local Rules, Fleet, Agreement, or another controlled file.

Relation of documents

The Business Plan system stays useful because it knows where its boundaries end.

DOCUMENT	ROLE
Business Plan Standard	Method for organizing the concept, evidence, assumptions, capital picture, risk, and planning decision.
Business Plan Record	The actual plan for this business, site, activity, and planning cycle. It contains the house-specific answers and sources.
Forecasting	Detailed financial model when used - assumptions, revenue / expense mechanics, cash flow, break-even, and forward scenarios.
Launch Roadmap	Sequence from the planning decision toward controlled first operations.
Road Beyond Launch	Post-launch evidence review, opportunity control, and growth decisions after the initial business is operating.

FILE DISCIPLINE

Do not place Social Security numbers, banking details, account credentials, or other sensitive identifiers in copies that circulate. An Operating Agreement remains a separate legal document maintained and reviewed through the appropriate legal file - it does not become a chapter of the Business Plan.

The plan may cite another controlled file by title, edition, or record reference. It should not duplicate that file merely to make the plan look longer or more complete.

09

Closing notice

The value of the plan is disciplined preparation before significant money, commitments, or operating promises are made.

This is an experience-based planning resource. It does not provide legal, accounting, tax, financial, investment, lending, insurance, valuation, employment, property, licensing, or other professional advice. It does not establish that a concept is lawful, insurable, financeable, profitable, valuable, or appropriate for a particular market.

The business is responsible for adapting the plan to its jurisdiction and activity, verifying current requirements, obtaining current quotes and professional guidance when needed, protecting confidential information, and deciding whether the evidence supports further investment.

CONTROL PRINCIPLE

Plan before investing. Verify before relying. Separate fact from estimate. Keep local feasibility ahead of asset purchase. Then record one decision: GO, ADJUST, CONTINUE RESEARCHING, or RECONSIDER.

Build the plan. Verify the assumptions. Understand the investment.

Then decide how to move forward.

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